

MARINA TRAINING PLAN

GYM + Half Marathon Roma. 14 September – 20 October. Race Tuesday 20 October in Rome. Three runs, three full-body gym days. The last long is 18 km on Saturday 10 October — ten days before the race.

- STRENGTH
- RUNNING
- HALF MARATHON

YOUR RACE TARGET

You already have a half in your legs, but 10 km still cooks you and the gym is brand new. This block is running-first. Longs go 12 → 14 → 16 → 18 km: two extra kilometres each Saturday. Gym is machine-based toning. Every gym day ends with banded pull-ups (you can do 3–4 now) plus abs. Leave 3 reps in the tank. Never smash the legs on Friday.

THE RULE THAT MATTERS

The 18 km on 10 October is the last hard aerobic day. After that you only remove fatigue. Longs stay Zone 2 — full sentences. If you cannot talk, you are too fast. Do not add a fourth run.

THE LONG-RUN LADDER

SAT 19 SEP	Long 1 — 12 km easy Zone 2
SAT 26 SEP	Long 2 — 14 km
SAT 3 OCT	Long 3 — 16 km
SAT 10 OCT	Last long — 18 km, 10 days out
SAT 17 OCT	Taper — 8 km shake-out
TUE 20 OCT	Race — Half Marathon Roma 21.1 km

Set the plan up once. Then train.

RUNNING ZONES

No paces to copy. Easy running is Zone 2: full sentences, nose breathing if you can. If 10 km already finishes you, the first kilometres were too fast. Half-marathon rhythm is controlled and repeatable, never a 10 km race.

Z1 Recovery

Walk / shake-out

Z2 Easy

Full sentences

Z3 Steady

Short sentences

Z4 Hard

Quality only, never the long

Z5 Very hard

Strides 15–20 s only

Half race rhythm

Sustainable, not a 10 km

RUN WARM-UP

8–10 min easy before every run. Open every long run slower than you think for the first 3 km. Walk 60 seconds only if you must, then resume easy. Do not turn the long into intervals.

ESTIMATED TRAINING TIME

Every session shows a realistic time range. It includes a normal warm-up, planned rests and the main work.

Example: 75–90 min means most athletes should complete the session inside that window. Extra equipment queues or long setup time are not included.

GYM NOTATION

3 × 8 = 3 sets of 8 reps.

RIR — Repetitions In Reserve: how many clean reps you could still perform at the end of the set. 2 RIR = stop with about 2 good reps left.

1RM — One-Repetition Maximum: the heaviest load you can lift for one technically clean rep.

%1RM

%1RM is a starting estimate. RIR decides the real load. Example: Squat 1 × 6 | 2 RIR | ~80% 1RM. If your 1RM is 100 kg, start near 80 kg. If you finish 6 reps and could still do about 2 clean reps, the load is correct. If you have no reps left, reduce the weight.

Top set: your heaviest work set for the day. **Back-off sets:** reduce the load slightly and complete the remaining sets at the prescribed RIR.

For machines and isolation work, do not test a true 1RM. Use the percentage only as a reference and match the prescribed RIR.

PULL-UPS + ABS

Every gym day ends with banded pull-ups, then abs. You can do 3–4 clean reps with a band today. Use the band that lets you get your chin over the bar without kicking. Stop at the last clean rep — never an ugly fifth.

If 4 reps become easy on every set, switch to a thinner band the next gym day. Abs stay controlled: dead bug, plank, V-ups or machine crunch. This is skill and tone, not a burnout.

WEEK 1 LEARN

14–20 September. First long at 12 km. Learn the week. Gym stays easy.

BUILD

THIS WEEK

Sunday is empty — do not add a fourth run. Every gym day ends with banded pull-ups (3–4 clean reps) plus abs. Lat Pulldown is Monday only. Seated Row is Wednesday only. Friday stays light so Saturday's 12 km can stay easy.

STRENGTH / GYM

MON 14 SEP

GYM 1

Toning / Push

EST. 40–50 MIN

Leg Press

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 90 s

STRENGTH

Chest Press

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Lat Pulldown

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Hip Abduction

2 × 15 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

Lying Leg Curl

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

PULL-UPS + ABS

1) Banded Pull-Up 3 × 3–4 | band | Rest 90 s | last clean rep 2) Dead Bug + Plank 2 × 6 / side then Front Plank 2 × 25 s

FOCUS

You can do 3–4 banded pull-ups today. Stop at the last clean rep. Then abs. Skill, not a max test.

WED 16 SEP

GYM 2

Toning / Pull

EST. 40–50 MIN

Hip Thrust Machine

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

STRENGTH

Seated Row

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Shoulder Press Machine

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Adductor Machine

2 × 15 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

Triceps Pushdown

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 45 s

PULL-UPS + ABS

1) Banded Pull-Up 3 × 3–4 | band | Rest 90 s | last clean rep 2) V-Ups + Side Plank 2 × 8 then Side Plank 2 × 20 s / side

FOCUS

You can do 3–4 banded pull-ups today. Stop at the last clean rep. Then abs. Skill, not a max test.

FRI 18 SEP

GYM 3

Toning / Light

EST. 35–45 MIN

Leg Extension

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

STRENGTH

Pec Deck

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

Face Pull

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

Cable Glute Kickback

2 × 12 / side | 3 RIR | Rest 45 s

Standing Calf Raise

2 × 15 | 3 RIR | Rest 45 s

PULL-UPS + ABS

1) Banded Pull-Up 3 × 3–4 | band | Rest 90 s | last clean rep 2) Machine Crunch + Plank 2 × 12 then Front Plank 2 × 25 s

FOCUS

You can do 3–4 banded pull-ups today. Stop at the last clean rep. Then abs. Skill, not a max test.

RUNNING

TUE 15 SEP

RUN

EASY / AEROBIC

EST. 40–50 MIN

6 km Zone 2. Full sentences the whole way.

- 8–10 min easy walk-jog.
- 6 km Zone 2. If you cannot talk, slow down.
- 4 min walk to close.

FOCUS

This run only works if it feels too easy. Save the legs for Saturday.

THU 17 SEP

RUN

EASY / STRIDES

EST. 40–50 MIN

EASY. STRIDES ARE FAST LEGS, NOT A SPRINT.

6 km easy. Finish with 4 short strides.

- 6 km Zone 2.
- 4 × 20 s controlled strides on a flat path. Walk back to recover.
- Stop each stride before you tighten up.

FOCUS

Strides teach the legs to turn over. They are not intervals.

SAT 19 SEP

RUN

LONG / 12 KM

EST. 75–95 MIN

ZONE 2 FOR THE WHOLE LONG.

12 km easy. First long of the block.

- 8–10 min easy. First 3 km slower than the rest.
- 12 km Zone 2. Full sentences.
- Walk 60 s only if you must, then resume easy. Do not sprint the last kilometres.

THE LADDER

12 today → 14 → 16 → 18 km on 10 October. Each long is only 2 km longer. Stay easy so next Saturday is possible.

FOCUS

If kilometre 10 already feels like a 10 km race, you started too fast. Finish the 12 km as a conversation.

WEEK 2 BUILD

21–27 September. Long 14 km. First real quality run, still short.

BUILD

THIS WEEK

Thursday is the only session that may feel honest. Saturday's 14 km stays easy. Friday gym stays light.

STRENGTH / GYM

MON 21 SEP

GYM 1

Toning / Push

EST. 45–55 MIN

Leg Press

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 90 s

STRENGTH

Chest Press

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Lat Pulldown

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Hip Abduction

3 × 15 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

Lying Leg Curl

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

PULL-UPS + ABS

1) Banded Pull-Up 4 × 3–4 | same band | Rest 90 s
2) Dead Bug + Plank 2 × 6 / side then Front Plank 2 × 25 s

FOCUS

You can do 3–4 banded pull-ups today. Stop at the last clean rep. Then abs. Skill, not a max test.

WED 23 SEP

GYM 2

Toning / Pull

EST. 45–55 MIN

Hip Thrust Machine

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

STRENGTH

Seated Row

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Shoulder Press Machine

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Adductor Machine

3 × 15 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

Triceps Pushdown

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 45 s

PULL-UPS + ABS

1) Banded Pull-Up 4 × 3–4 | same band | Rest 90 s
2) V-Ups + Side Plank 2 × 8 then Side Plank 2 × 20 s / side

FOCUS

You can do 3–4 banded pull-ups today. Stop at the last clean rep. Then abs. Skill, not a max test.

FRI 25 SEP

GYM 3

Toning / Light

EST. 35–45 MIN

Leg Extension

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

STRENGTH

Pec Deck

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

Face Pull

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

Cable Glute Kickback

2 × 12 / side | 3 RIR | Rest 45 s

Standing Calf Raise

2 × 15 | 3 RIR | Rest 45 s

PULL-UPS + ABS

1) Banded Pull-Up 4 × 3–4 | same band | Rest 90 s
2) Machine Crunch + Plank 2 × 12 then Front Plank 2 × 25 s

FOCUS

You can do 3–4 banded pull-ups today. Stop at the last clean rep. Then abs. Skill, not a max test.

RUNNING

TUE 22 SEP

RUN

EASY / AEROBIC

EST. 45–55 MIN

7 km Zone 2. Same rule: full sentences.

- 8 min easy.
- 7 km Zone 2.
- If Tuesday leaves you cooked for Thursday, you ran it too hard.

FOCUS

Volume is the point. Not pace.

THU 24 SEP

RUN

QUALITY / STEADY

EST. 45–55 MIN

ZONE 3 ON THE 3-MINUTE PIECES ONLY. SHORT SENTENCES.

First quality dose. Repeatable, not a time trial.

- 12–15 min Zone 2.
- 4 × 3 min Zone 3. Jog 90 s easy after each.
- 10 min Zone 2 to close.

QUALITY

The last 3-minute piece should look like the first. If it falls apart, you started too fast.

FOCUS

One quality run a week is enough. Do not add extra speed.

SAT 26 SEP

RUN

LONG / 14 KM

EST. 85–105 MIN

ZONE 2. TWO KM MORE THAN LAST SATURDAY.

14 km easy. Same feel as the 12 km.

- 8–10 min easy. First 3 km slower than the rest.
- 14 km Zone 2. Water with you.
- Last 2 km stay easy. Do not test the half.

FUEL

Breakfast before you leave. If you are out longer than 90 min, take a gel or a few chews around minute 60.

FOCUS

14 km is only +2 km. The jump is small on purpose.

WEEK 3 RHYTHM

28 September – 4 October. Long 16 km. Taste race rhythm once.

SPECIFIC



THIS WEEK

Thursday practises race rhythm in short pieces. Saturday's 16 km stays easy — not race pace.

STRENGTH / GYM

MON 28 SEP

GYM 1

Toning / Push

EST. 45–55 MIN

Leg Press

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 90 s

STRENGTH

Chest Press

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Lat Pulldown

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Hip Abduction

3 × 15 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

Lying Leg Curl

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

PULL-UPS + ABS

1) Banded Pull-Up 4 × 4 | same band, or thinner if 4 are easy | Rest 90 s 2) Dead Bug + Plank 2 × 6 / side then Front Plank 2 × 25 s

FOCUS

You can do 3–4 banded pull-ups today. Stop at the last clean rep. Then abs. Skill, not a max test.

WED 30 SEP

GYM 2

Toning / Pull

EST. 45–55 MIN

Hip Thrust Machine

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

STRENGTH

Seated Row

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Shoulder Press Machine

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Adductor Machine

3 × 15 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

Triceps Pushdown

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 45 s

PULL-UPS + ABS

1) Banded Pull-Up 4 × 4 | same band, or thinner if 4 are easy | Rest 90 s 2) V-Ups + Side Plank 2 × 8 then Side Plank 2 × 20 s / side

FOCUS

You can do 3–4 banded pull-ups today. Stop at the last clean rep. Then abs. Skill, not a max test.

FRI 2 OCT

GYM 3

Toning / Light

EST. 35–45 MIN

Leg Extension

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

STRENGTH

Pec Deck

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

Face Pull

3 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

Cable Glute Kickback

3 × 12 / side | 3 RIR | Rest 45 s

Standing Calf Raise

2 × 15 | 3 RIR | Rest 45 s

PULL-UPS + ABS

1) Banded Pull-Up 4 × 4 | same band, or thinner if 4 are easy | Rest 90 s 2) Machine Crunch + Plank 2 × 12 then Front Plank 2 × 25 s

FOCUS

You can do 3–4 banded pull-ups today. Stop at the last clean rep. Then abs. Skill, not a max test.

RUNNING

TUE 29 SEP

RUN

EASY / AEROBIC

EST. 45–55 MIN

7–8 km Zone 2.

- 8 min easy.
- 7–8 km Zone 2. Choose 7 km if the legs are heavy.
- You must be able to talk.

FOCUS

Tuesday never steals Saturday.

THU 1 OCT

RUN

QUALITY / RHYTHM

EST. 50–60 MIN

HALF RHYTHM ON THE 6-MINUTE PIECES. CONTROLLED, NOT A 10 KM.

Feel race rhythm without racing.

- 15 min Zone 2.
- 3 × 6 min at half-marathon rhythm. Jog 2 min easy after each.
- 10 min Zone 2 to close.

RHYTHM

Half rhythm is 'I can hold this'. If you are gasping it is a 10 km, not a half. Slow down.

FOCUS

This is the most specific quality of the block. Once is enough.

SAT 3 OCT

RUN

LONG / 16 KM

EST. 95–115 MIN

ZONE 2. LAST LONG BEFORE THE 18 KM.

16 km easy. Time on your feet, not pace.

- 8–10 min easy. First 3 km slower than the rest.
- 16 km Zone 2. Water. Gel around minute 60–70.
- If the last 3 km feel honest, that is fine — they stay Zone 2, not a surge.

NEXT SATURDAY

The 18 km on 10 October is the last long, ten days before the race. Arrive at that run healthy, not heroic today.

FOCUS

16 km is +2 km again. Same easy feel as 12 and 14.

WEEK 4 PEAK

5–11 October. Protect Saturday. The 18 km on the 10th is the last hard day.

PEAK

THIS WEEK

Thursday stays easy on purpose. Friday gym is activation only. The 18 km on Saturday 10 October is ten days before the race — after that you only taper.

STRENGTH / GYM

MON 5 OCT

GYM 1

Toning / Push

EST. 35–45 MIN

Leg Press

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 90 s

STRENGTH

Chest Press

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Lat Pulldown

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Hip Abduction

2 × 15 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

Lying Leg Curl

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

PULL-UPS + ABS

1) Banded Pull-Up 3 × 3 | easy band | Rest 90 s
2) Dead Bug + Plank 2 × 6 / side then Front Plank 2 × 25 s

FOCUS

You can do 3–4 banded pull-ups today. Stop at the last clean rep. Then abs. Skill, not a max test.

WED 7 OCT

GYM 2

Toning / Pull

EST. 35–45 MIN

Hip Thrust Machine

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

STRENGTH

Seated Row

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Shoulder Press Machine

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 75 s

Adductor Machine

2 × 15 | 3 RIR | Rest 60 s

Triceps Pushdown

2 × 12 | 3 RIR | Rest 45 s

PULL-UPS + ABS

1) Banded Pull-Up 3 × 3 | easy band | Rest 90 s
2) V-Ups + Side Plank 2 × 8 then Side Plank 2 × 20 s / side

FOCUS

You can do 3–4 banded pull-ups today. Stop at the last clean rep. Then abs. Skill, not a max test.

FRI 9 OCT

GYM 3

Activation

EST. 25–35 MIN

Leg Extension

2 × 12 | 4 RIR | Rest 60 s

Pec Deck

2 × 12 | 4 RIR | Rest 60 s

Face Pull

2 × 12 | 4 RIR | Rest 60 s

Standing Calf Raise

2 × 12 | 4 RIR | Rest 45 s

PULL-UPS + ABS

1) Banded Pull-Up 3 × 3 | easy band | Rest 90 s
2) Machine Crunch + Plank 2 × 12 then Front Plank 2 × 25 s

FOCUS

You can do 3–4 banded pull-ups today. Stop at the last clean rep. Then abs. Skill, not a max test.

RUNNING

TUE 6 OCT

RUN

EASY / AEROBIC

EST. 40–50 MIN

6 km Zone 2. Freshness over kilometres.

- 1 6 km Zone 2.
- 2 Finish better than you started.

FOCUS

Do not sneak in extra kilometres this week.

THU 8 OCT

RUN

EASY / STRIDES

EST. 35–45 MIN

EASY. SATURDAY IS THE SESSION.

5 km easy + 4 strides. Keep the 18 km intact.

- 1 5 km Zone 2.
- 2 4 × 20 s strides. Walk back.
- 3 Stop. Go home.

FOCUS

Thursday is not quality this week.

SAT 10 OCT

RUN

LAST LONG / 18 KM

EST. 110–130 MIN

ZONE 2. LAST LONG. TEN DAYS BEFORE THE RACE.

18 km easy. Then the hard work is done.

- 1 8–10 min easy. First 3 km slower than the rest.
- 2 18 km Zone 2. Water. Gel at 60 min and again near 100 min if you need it.
- 3 Do not finish at race pace. The point is to complete 18 km and recover.

TEN DAYS OUT

Race is Tuesday 20 October. This is the last long. From tomorrow you only remove fatigue. No extra 16 km, no one more quality.

FOCUS

18 km is +2 km from last Saturday. Same conversation pace. Then taper.

WEEK 5 TAPER

12–18 October. Take fatigue out. Two gym days only. Saturday is 8 km.

TAPER

THIS WEEK

The 18 km is done. Gym drops to Monday and Wednesday. Friday is empty. Do not test yourself.

STRENGTH / GYM

MON 12 OCT

GYM 1

Toning / Push

EST. 30–40 MIN

Leg Press

2 × 12 | 4 RIR | Rest 90 s

STRENGTH

Chest Press

2 × 12 | 4 RIR | Rest 75 s

Lat Pulldown

2 × 12 | 4 RIR | Rest 75 s

Hip Abduction

2 × 12 | 4 RIR | Rest 60 s

PULL-UPS + ABS

1) Banded Pull-Up 3 × 3 | easy band | Rest 90 s 2) Dead Bug + Plank 2 × 6 / side then Front Plank 2 × 25 s

FOCUS

You can do 3–4 banded pull-ups today. Stop at the last clean rep. Then abs. Skill, not a max test.

WED 14 OCT

GYM 2

Toning / Pull

EST. 30–40 MIN

Hip Thrust Machine

2 × 12 | 4 RIR | Rest 75 s

STRENGTH

Seated Row

2 × 12 | 4 RIR | Rest 75 s

Shoulder Press Machine

2 × 12 | 4 RIR | Rest 75 s

Adductor Machine

2 × 12 | 4 RIR | Rest 60 s

PULL-UPS + ABS

1) Banded Pull-Up 3 × 3 | easy band | Rest 90 s 2) V-Ups + Side Plank 2 × 8 then Side Plank 2 × 20 s / side

FOCUS

You can do 3–4 banded pull-ups today. Stop at the last clean rep. Then abs. Skill, not a max test.

RUNNING

TUE 13 OCT

RUN

EASY / TAPER

EST. 35–45 MIN

5–6 km Zone 2. Genuinely easy.

- 5–6 km Zone 2.
- Finish light.

FOCUS

Taper means you feel under-trained. That is the point.

THU 15 OCT

RUN

OPENERS / RHYTHM

EST. 35–45 MIN

MOSTLY EASY. FOUR SHORT TASTES OF RACE RHYTHM.

Remind the legs of race rhythm. Stop fresh.

- 15–20 min Zone 2.
- 4 × 1 min at half-marathon rhythm. Jog 1 min after each.
- 4 × 20 s strides. Walk back. Stop.

TAPER

These minutes are a reminder, not a workout. If you finish tired, you did too much.

FOCUS

Openers, then home. Saturday is only 8 km.

SAT 17 OCT

RUN

SHAKE-OUT / 8 KM

EST. 45–55 MIN

8 km easy + 4 strides. Three days before the race.

- 8 km Zone 2.
- 4 × 20 s strides.
- Sunday is empty.

FOCUS

Last run before Monday's shake-out. Keep it boring.

WEEK 6 RACE

19–20 October. Arrive light. Race Tuesday — Half Marathon Roma.

RACE

THIS WEEK

No gym. Monday is a short shake-out. Tuesday is the half. First 3 km slower than the rhythm you want to hold.

RUNNING

MON 19 OCT

SHAKE-OUT

RUN

EST. 30–40 MIN

25 min easy + 4 strides. Then rest.

- 1 25 min Zone 2.
- 2 4 x 20 s strides.
- 3 Normal meals. Lay out race kit. Sleep.

FOCUS

Legs should feel springy, not trained.

TUE 20 OCT

RACE DAY

RUN

EST. 120–160 MIN

HALF MARATHON ROMA 21.1 KM. CONTROLLED, NOT A 10 KM.

Race. First 3 km slower than the rhythm you want to hold.

- 1 Warm-up: 8–10 min easy jog, 3 strides, then to the start.
- 2 km 1–3: slower than goal rhythm. Let people go.
- 3 km 4–16: half-marathon rhythm. Short sentences. Even effort.
- 4 km 16–21.1: only then, if the legs are still yours, squeeze.

DO NOT

Do not race the first 10 km. That is how you fade. You ran 18 km ten days ago — trust the easy engine, not a fast open.

FOCUS

Hold back early. The race starts at kilometre 16, not at the gun.